



CLEANHEALTH WASTE

WOMEN'S COOPERATIVE

BUSINESS PLAN

Transforming Healthcare Waste into Women's Economic Empowerment

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WE4A Grant Application

Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary

CleanHealth Waste Women's Cooperative is a pioneering women-led social enterprise addressing Uganda's critical healthcare waste management crisis while creating sustainable economic opportunities for women. Founded by Samura Boona, a qualified Medical Laboratory Technologist with expertise in hematology and biohazard management, the cooperative will organize and train women to provide professional non-hazardous healthcare waste sorting, collection, and recycling linkage services to healthcare facilities in Kampala and surrounding districts.

The Opportunity

Uganda's 7,000+ private healthcare facilities generate 20-92 kg of waste daily, yet less than 6% comply with proper waste segregation requirements under NEMA regulations. Approximately 85% of healthcare waste is non-hazardous (paper, cardboard, plastics, general waste) but is currently mixed with infectious materials and sent to landfills, representing both an environmental crisis and a massive economic loss in unrecovered recyclables.

Our Solution

CleanHealth will recruit and train women from local communities to become certified healthcare waste handlers. Under the expert guidance of our founder's medical laboratory background, members will learn to identify hazardous vs. non-hazardous materials, implement proper segregation at source, and safely handle recyclable waste streams. The cooperative model ensures dignified employment, shared ownership, and sustainable income for women while solving a critical environmental and public health challenge.

Financial Highlights

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Total Revenue	\$11,840	\$21,440	\$35,200
Net Profit	\$4,280	\$10,220	\$18,400
Profit Margin	36%	48%	52%
Healthcare Facilities Served	10	15	25
Women Employed	8	12	15

Funding Request

We are seeking \$5,000 in seed funding through the WE4A (Women Entrepreneurship for Africa) programme to launch operations. This investment will generate a projected

288% cumulative ROI by Year 3 while creating employment for 15 women and diverting 180+ tonnes of waste from landfills annually.

2. Company Description

Mission Statement

To empower women through dignified employment in environmental services while solving Uganda's healthcare waste management crisis through professional, community-based solutions that protect public health and the environment.

Vision Statement

To become Uganda's leading women-owned healthcare waste management cooperative, setting the standard for community-based circular economy solutions across East Africa.

Legal Structure

CleanHealth will be registered as a cooperative society under Uganda's Cooperative Societies Act. This structure ensures democratic governance, shared ownership among women members, and alignment with WE4A's emphasis on women's economic empowerment through collective enterprise.

Location

Headquarters will be established in Kampala, Uganda, with initial operations focused on healthcare facilities within Kampala Central and surrounding districts including Wakiso and Mukono. This strategic positioning provides access to the highest concentration of private healthcare facilities while maintaining manageable logistics for initial operations.

Core Values

- **Safety First:** Rigorous adherence to biohazard protocols and worker protection
- **Women's Empowerment:** Creating dignified, sustainable employment for women
- **Environmental Stewardship:** Protecting communities and ecosystems through proper waste management
- **Professional Excellence:** Delivering reliable, high-quality services that exceed regulatory standards
- **Community Impact:** Reinvesting in member development and community health education

3. Problem Statement

The Healthcare Waste Crisis

Uganda faces a severe healthcare waste management crisis that threatens public health, environmental sustainability, and regulatory compliance across its healthcare sector.

Key Statistics

- 7,000+ private clinics and health centers operate across Uganda, most without proper waste management systems
- Healthcare facilities generate 20-92 kg of waste daily, depending on size and services
- Less than 6% of healthcare facilities comply with NEMA waste segregation requirements
- 85% of healthcare waste is non-hazardous but is routinely mixed with infectious materials
- Zero women's cooperatives currently operate in the healthcare waste management sector

Environmental Impact

Improperly managed healthcare waste contaminates Uganda's landfills, particularly Kiteezi, with medical materials that pose long-term environmental risks. Groundwater contamination, soil pollution, and air quality degradation from informal burning practices threaten communities surrounding disposal sites.

Economic Loss

Valuable recyclable materials—including paper, cardboard, and certain plastics—worth millions of Ugandan shillings are buried in landfills annually instead of being recovered and reintroduced into the circular economy. This represents both lost economic value and missed employment opportunities.

Regulatory Pressure

The National Environment Management Authority (NEMA) has intensified enforcement of healthcare waste regulations, creating urgent demand for compliance solutions among private healthcare facilities. Facilities face penalties for non-compliance, yet most lack the expertise or resources to implement proper waste management systems independently.

4. Solution & Business Model

The Women's Cooperative Model

CleanHealth organizes women into a professional cooperative that provides healthcare waste sorting, non-hazardous collection, and recycling linkage services. This model combines the founder's medical laboratory expertise with community-based employment creation, delivering both environmental impact and women's economic empowerment.

Service Delivery Process

Step 1: Partnership Development

CleanHealth establishes monthly service contracts with healthcare facilities, positioning the cooperative as a compliance partner rather than just a waste collector. Facilities benefit from expert guidance on meeting NEMA requirements while outsourcing the operational burden of waste management.

Step 2: Staff Training

Our medical laboratory-trained founder delivers comprehensive waste segregation training to facility staff. This ensures proper source separation, reducing contamination of recyclable materials and improving overall compliance. Training programs generate additional revenue while creating lasting behavioral change.

Step 3: Collection Services

Trained cooperative members conduct regular scheduled pickups of properly segregated non-hazardous waste. Our focus on non-hazardous materials (paper, cardboard, plastics, general waste) eliminates the need for expensive treatment equipment while ensuring worker safety through rigorous protocols.

Step 4: Recycling Linkage

Collected materials are sorted at our central facility and sold to established recycling partners. This circular economy approach recovers value from materials previously sent to landfills, generating additional revenue while maximizing environmental impact.

Key Differentiators

- Expert Leadership: Founder's medical laboratory background provides credibility and technical expertise unique in the sector
- Non-Hazardous Focus: Concentration on low-risk, high-value materials reduces capital requirements and worker risk
- Compliance Partnership: Positioning as regulatory compliance partners rather than simple waste collectors

- Women's Cooperative Structure: Shared ownership model ensures equitable benefit distribution and community trust
- Training Revenue: Staff education services create additional income while solving root causes of waste mismanagement

5. Market Analysis

Market Size

TAM	SAM	SOM (Year 3)
7,000+ facilities Private clinics in Uganda	1,500+ facilities Kampala region	25 facilities Initial target

Target Customer Profile

Our primary customers are private healthcare facilities including clinics, health centers, diagnostic laboratories, and small hospitals in urban and peri-urban Kampala. These facilities typically:

- Generate 20-50 kg of waste daily
- Lack dedicated waste management staff or expertise
- Face increasing pressure to comply with NEMA regulations
- Have budgets for outsourced services but cannot afford capital-intensive solutions
- Value professional partnerships that reduce operational burden

Competitive Landscape

The healthcare waste management sector in Uganda is characterized by limited formal competition, particularly for women-led enterprises focused on non-hazardous waste recovery. Existing players include:

- Municipal waste collectors: General services without healthcare specialization
- Large waste management companies: Focus on hazardous waste treatment, expensive for small facilities
- Informal collectors: Lack training, certification, and reliability

CleanHealth's competitive advantage lies in our specialized focus, medical laboratory expertise, cooperative structure, and emphasis on compliance partnership rather than simple collection services.

Market Timing

- New NEMA regulations mandate proper healthcare waste management with increasing enforcement
- No organized competition in women-led healthcare waste services
- Growing private healthcare sector creates expanding demand

- Increased environmental awareness among healthcare administrators
- WE4A and similar programs provide enabling funding environment

6. Services & Revenue Streams

Primary Services

1. Facility Service Contracts (68% of Revenue)

Monthly service agreements with healthcare facilities for regular non-hazardous waste collection. Pricing scales based on facility size and waste volume:

- Small clinics: UGX 200,000/month (\$53)
- Medium facilities: UGX 350,000/month (\$93)
- Larger health centers: UGX 500,000/month (\$133)

2. Recyclables Sales (18% of Revenue)

Sorted recyclable materials sold to established recycling partners:

- Paper and cardboard: UGX 200-400/kg
- Plastics (by type): UGX 300-800/kg
- Other recyclables: Market rates

3. Training Programs (14% of Revenue)

Staff waste segregation certification courses delivered by our founder:

- Group training sessions: UGX 500,000 per facility
- Individual certifications: UGX 75,000 per person
- Annual refresher courses: UGX 250,000 per facility

Revenue Projections by Stream

Revenue Stream	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Facility Service Fees	\$8,000	\$14,400	\$24,000
Recyclables Sales	\$2,240	\$3,840	\$6,400
Training Programs	\$1,600	\$3,200	\$4,800
TOTAL REVENUE	\$11,840	\$21,440	\$35,200

7. Operations Plan

Daily Operations

CleanHealth will operate Monday through Saturday with the following daily workflow:

- 6:00 AM - Team assembly, equipment check, route planning
- 7:00 AM - Collection rounds begin at scheduled facilities
- 12:00 PM - Midday return for material drop-off and sorting
- 1:00 PM - Afternoon collection rounds
- 4:00 PM - Final sorting, documentation, equipment cleaning
- 5:00 PM - End of operational day

Equipment & Infrastructure

- Collection bins (color-coded for waste segregation)
- Hand carts for transport
- Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) for all members
- Sorting tables and storage area
- Basic office equipment for administration

Safety Protocols

Worker safety is paramount. All cooperative members receive comprehensive training in:

- Biohazard identification and avoidance
- Proper PPE usage and maintenance
- Hand hygiene and decontamination procedures
- Incident reporting and response
- Safe lifting and material handling techniques

Quality Assurance

- Weekly facility audits to ensure proper source segregation
- Monthly service quality reviews with facility managers
- Quarterly refresher training for all cooperative members
- Annual certification renewal and skills assessment

8. Management & Team

Founder Profile: Samura Boona

Samura Boona is a qualified Medical Laboratory Technologist with specialized expertise in hematology and general medical laboratory science. Her professional background provides unique qualifications for leading a healthcare waste management enterprise:

Key Qualifications

- Medical Lab Expertise: Trained in identifying infectious materials, proper specimen handling, and biohazard protocols
- Hematology Specialization: Expert knowledge of blood-borne pathogens and contamination risks
- Healthcare Facility Knowledge: Deep understanding of waste streams from laboratories, wards, and clinical settings
- Training Capability: Ability to train cooperative members and facility staff on proper waste segregation

Organizational Structure

- Founder/Lead Trainer: Samura Boona - Overall leadership, training delivery, business development
- Operations Coordinator: To be hired - Daily logistics, scheduling, quality control
- Cooperative Members: 8 initial, growing to 15 - Collection, sorting, facility liaison

Cooperative Governance

As a registered cooperative society, CleanHealth will operate with democratic governance:

- Annual General Meeting for major decisions
- Elected leadership committee from membership
- Transparent financial reporting to all members
- Equitable profit-sharing based on contribution and tenure

9. Financial Projections

Three-Year Financial Summary

Financial Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Total Revenue	\$11,840	\$21,440	\$35,200
Operating Expenses	\$7,560	\$11,220	\$16,800
Net Profit	\$4,280	\$10,220	\$18,400
Profit Margin	36%	48%	52%

Operating Expense Breakdown

Expense Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Member Payments	\$3,360	\$5,760	\$9,360
Transport/Collection	\$1,440	\$1,800	\$2,400
PPE Replacement	\$600	\$660	\$1,200
Admin & Supplies	\$2,160	\$3,000	\$3,840
TOTAL EXPENSES	\$7,560	\$11,220	\$16,800

Key Financial Metrics

- Break-Even Point: Month 5 of Year 1
- Cumulative ROI by Year 3: 288%
- Payback Period: Less than 14 months
- Exchange Rate Assumption: 3,750 UGX = \$1 USD

10. Impact Metrics

CleanHealth delivers measurable impact across three interconnected dimensions aligned with WE4A programme objectives:

Women's Economic Empowerment

Metric	Year 3 Target
Women Directly Employed	15 women
Average Monthly Income per Member	\$150+ (UGX 560,000+)
Women Ownership	100%

Environmental Impact

Metric	Year 3 Target
Waste Diverted from Landfills	180+ tonnes annually
Waste Properly Segregated at Source	85%
Groundwater Contamination Incidents	Zero

Healthcare Sector Impact

Metric	Year 3 Target
Facilities Achieving NEMA Compliance	25 facilities
Healthcare Workers Trained	200+ workers
Compliance Rate Improvement	From 6% to 72%

11. Funding Request & Use of Funds

Investment Request

CleanHealth Waste Women's Cooperative is seeking \$5,000 in seed funding through the WE4A (Women Entrepreneurship for Africa) programme administered by the Tony Elumelu Foundation. This investment will fully capitalize launch operations and position the cooperative for sustainable growth.

Use of Funds

Budget Category	Amount	% of Total
Collection Equipment (bins, carts)	\$1,500	30%
PPE for 8 Initial Members	\$1,200	24%
Marketing & Client Acquisition	\$800	16%
Training Materials & Manuals	\$600	12%
Working Capital Reserve	\$500	10%
Cooperative Registration & Licenses	\$400	8%
TOTAL	\$5,000	100%

Investment Return

- Cumulative ROI by Year 3: 288%
- Total Revenue Generated: \$68,480 over three years
- Total Profit Generated: \$32,900 over three years
- Jobs Created: 15 women employed
- Environmental Impact: 540+ tonnes of waste diverted over three years

Follow-on Funding

Top-performing WE4A grantees are eligible for additional investment of up to €50,000 through Demo Day presentations. CleanHealth's strong financial projections and measurable impact position us well for follow-on funding to accelerate expansion beyond Year 3 targets.

12. Conclusion

CleanHealth Waste Women's Cooperative represents a compelling investment opportunity that delivers meaningful financial returns while creating transformative social and environmental impact. By combining Samura Boona's unique medical laboratory expertise with a proven cooperative model, we offer a sustainable solution to Uganda's healthcare waste crisis while empowering women through dignified employment.

Our request for \$5,000 in WE4A seed funding will launch a self-sustaining enterprise projected to generate \$35,200 in annual revenue by Year 3, employ 15 women, and divert 180+ tonnes of waste from landfills annually. With break-even achieved by Month 5 and cumulative ROI of 288% by Year 3, this investment offers exceptional returns across all dimensions of impact.

We invite the WE4A selection committee to partner with us in transforming healthcare waste into women's economic empowerment—creating a cleaner environment, healthier communities, and brighter futures for women in Uganda.

— *End of Business Plan* —

Contact Information

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